Diploma in Lightroom

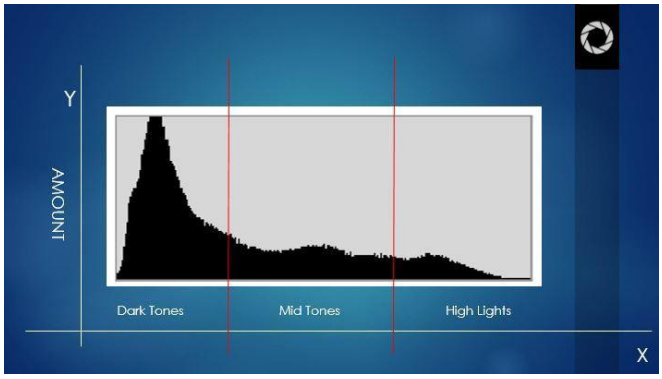
# Creative Editing

## What is the Development Module?

The Develop module in Lightroom lets you adjust the colour and tonal scale of your photos as well as crop photos, remove red eye, and make other corrections. All the adjustments you make in Lightroom are non- destructive. With non-destructive editing, your original file is not altered, whether it's a camera raw file or a rendered file such as a JPEG or TIFF. Your edits are stored in Lightroom as a set of instructions that are applied to your photo in memory. Non-destructive editing means you can explore and create different versions of your photo without degrading your original image data.

## The Histogram

The histogram is the representation of the tonal distribution in a picture. It tells us how many pixels have a certain tone and where they are located.




If we break it down, we can see that:

- The area on the left represents the distribution of the dark pixels in the image
- The area in the middle represents the distribution of the mid tones in the image
- The area on the right represents the distribution of the bright pixels in the image

The Histogram can have many different shapes, depending on what we photograph. There's not really a perfect shape. If we learn how to read it, it tells us:

How bright or dark, how soft or contrasted is an image. If we have **spikes,** like in the Histogram above, it is totally normal. It is just telling us that we have a high volume of pixels having a certain tone (in this case, a lot of dark pixels as it is a night shot)

## Why should I learn how to read it?

The Histogram is deeply related to the exposure and it is a good indicator of it.
So, instead of looking at the LCD screen of our camera, which could be misleading, we look at the histogram.

Did you ever look at your LCD screen on a sunny day and thought?
Am I too underexposed or overexposed, and you couldn't tell?

The reason why we look at the histogram is because it doesn't change whether we are looking at the pictures under the sun, at night or through different monitor screens having different luminosities! Wewill always have a correct representation of our exposure.

*The Histogram is covered in depth in our Photography course

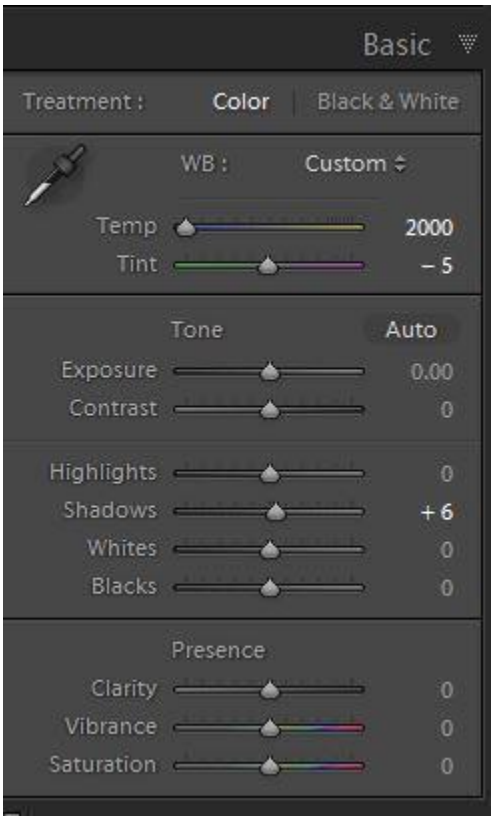
## Shadows/Highlights Clipping Indicators

To prevent unnecessary clipping or loss of image detail, turn on the clipping indicators **before** you maketonal adjustments. To do this, click on the triangle icons located at the top of the Histogram.

The clipping indicators will tell you if you are losing details in the Highlights or in the Shadows.

NOTES:

## The Basic Panel – your adjustments




With the Basic panel you can adjust the white balance, tonal scale and colour saturation of a photo, including Clarity and Vibrance. If desired, you can refine global colour and tonal adjustments in the Tone Curve and HSL/Colour/B&W panels

- **Temperature**: Changes the white balance of the photograph, you can make it colder or warmer
- **Tint:** You can add a touch of magenta or green, just moving the slider
- **Exposure:** By clicking on the exposure slider, you can make a photo brighter or darker alltogether

**If you want to change the exposure on specific areas of your image, work on the following sliders**:

- **Highlights** (reduces or increases the luminosity of the bright parts of your image)
- **Shadows** (reduces or increases the luminosity of the dark parts of your image)
- **Whites** (helps you to get a better control on the bright areas in combination with the **highlights** slider)
- **Blacks** (helps you to get a better control on the dark areas in combination with the **Shadows slider)**

## Presence

- **Clarity**: Increases the contrast in the mid-tones. A negative value will create a 'foggy' effect
- **Vibrace**: Is a smart-tool which cleverly increases the intensity of the more muted coloursand leaves the already well-saturated colours alone. Vibrance also prevents skin tones from becoming overly saturated and unnatural
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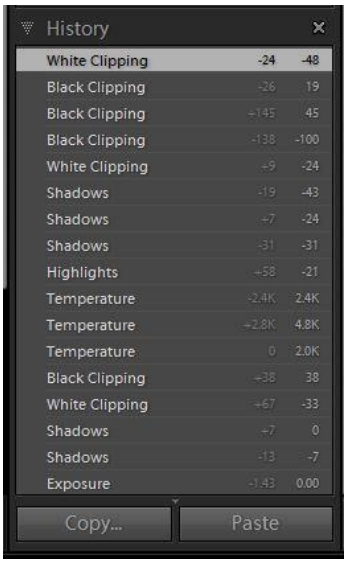
- **Saturation**: Saturation pushes up the intensity of all colours in your shot, regardless of the starting point of the colours.

## History




Like Photoshop, Lightroom has a History feature that shows a list of the changes that you have applied to an image. It can be used to go back on your steps whenever you want. Unlike the Photoshop history, the Lightroom history don't disappear when you close the programme – it remains accessible from one instance of Lightroom to the next.

## Snapshot

Think of a snapshot as something you would use when you enhance your image and you have a few different editing ideas, or effects that you want to try on the photo. It would be silly to keep hitting the reset button and start over again each time or to go back using the history. When you are happy with your photo, but you want to experiment a little bit more, just create a Snapshot. It will allow you to save your progress, without having the fear of forgetting your settings.

## Virtual Copies

As the name suggests, Virtual Copies are copies of an image file created virtually. In other words, they arecopies of your virtual reference, not copies of your physical images stored in your computer or in your external source ( external hard disk ).

With virtual Copies you can create several versions of a single photograph, post-process them differentlyand compare them or export both. Have a look at the image above, you will see 3 Virtual Copies of a singlephotograph, all processed differently.

In order to create a virtual copy you have to be first in your **development module**, then Command+Click (MAC users) or Left Click (pc users) on an image, and select: **Create Virtual Copy.** Otherwise, select an image and click CTRL+' (shortcut). You can create as many virtual copies as you want.

## How do I recognise a virtual copy?

The Virtual Copies have a little triangle on the bottom left corner of the thumbnail. You can even apply your **pre-sets** and **snapshots** on them!